

CT465: Essence of Traditional Indian Knowledge

SET A, (CSE)

Full Marks: 30 | Time: 1hr 30 mins

Part A:

1x5 = 5

Answer any five questions in brief:

1. What is the meaning of the Sanskrit phrase "*Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam*"?
2. Name the archaeologist who started excavating Mohenjo-daro in 1921.
3. Define urbanization and civilization.
4. Name two heterodox schools of Indian philosophy.
5. Explain the meaning of "Atman" and "Brahman" in Indian philosophy.
6. Just consider how terrible the day of your death will be. Others will go on speaking, and you will not be able to argue back."— was said by which Indian reformer to highlight India's argumentative tradition?

Part B:

5x3 = 15

Answer the following questions (any three)

1. The debate between Adi Shankaracharya (Advaita) and Mandana Mishra (Mimamsa) is often called 'Philosophy vs. Practice'. Compare and contrast the positions of Shankaracharya and Mandana Mishra, and discuss how this debate influenced the development of Indian spiritual thought.
2. Amartya Sen argues, "*A defeated argument that refuses to be obliterated can remain very alive.*" How does Sen use this idea to explain the survival of multiple perspectives in the Indian argumentative tradition?
3. Examine Sen's claim that argumentation and heterodoxy underpin Indian democracy. How do historical practices like śāstrārtha debates, Buddhist councils, and Akbar's Ibadat Khana support this claim?
4. Write a short note on the Lokāyata/Cārvāka school.
5. Briefly describe how the Indus Valley Civilization was an advanced urban society.

Part C:

10x1=10

Answer the following comprehensively (any one)

1. V. Gordon Childe viewed the emergence of urban civilization as a 'revolution' rather than a gradual evolution. Analyze this statement in the light of his 10 characteristics of the earliest cities.
2. Discuss Amartya Sen's use of Emperor Ashoka as an example of India's tradition of tolerant debate and pluralism. How does Ashoka's approach show that argumentative culture in India was both philosophical and political, anticipating modern democratic values.

End-Term Examination , Autumn 2025
Course Title : Essence of Traditional Indian Knowledge (CT-465)
SET: A (BTECH, CSE + MTECH)
Full Marks:50 marks | 2 hours

Part A: WRITTEN TEST (Total Marks:10)

Choose the correct answer from the following:

1x10=10

1. Which term best describes Indian philosophy?

- A. Darśana*
- B. Prakṛti*
- C. Karma*
- D. Mokṣa*

2. Mīmāṃsā is mainly concerned with

- A. Logical analysis*
- B. Ritual action and dharma*
- C. Meditation*
- D. Creation theory*

3. Ahimsa in Jainism means:

- A) Truth*
- B) Non-violence*
- C) Non-stealing*
- D) Meditation*

4. Buddhism was founded by

- A. Mahavira*
- B. Kapila*
- C. Gautama Buddha*
- D. Patanjali*

5. Nyāya primarily accepts how many valid means of knowledge (pramāṇas)?

- A. Two*
- B. Four*
- C. Six*
- D. One*

Turn the page

6. "Purusha and Prakriti" as two fundamental realities belong to which school?

- A. Samkhya
- B. Vedanta
- C. Charvaka
- D. Nyaya

7. The Yoga system of Indian philosophy is formally presented in:

- A) Yoga Upaniṣad
- B) Yoga Sūtras of Patañjali
- C) Bhagavad Gītā
- D) Nyāya Sūtras

8. The central concern of Vedānta philosophy is:

- A. The nature of logic and inference
- B. The relationship between Ātman and Brahman
- C. The classification of atoms and substances
- D. The path of non-violence

9. You see smoke rising from a hill and conclude that there must be fire there. This type of knowledge is obtained by:

- A. Pratyakṣa (Perception)
- B. Anumāna (Inference)
- C. Upamāna (Comparison/Analogy)
- D. Śabda (Verbal testimony)

10. Which of the following is the path taught by Buddha to end suffering?

- A. Eight Limbs of Yoga
- B. Four Noble Truths
- C. The Middle Path
- D. Karma and Dharma

Or

1. Write about the contribution of all nine schools of Indian philosophy to Indian thought. 10

Part B: ASSIGNMENT (Total Marks: 40)

Answer any one from the following.

40x1=40

- 5 marks
- 1. Discuss the meaning and importance of cultural heritage. Also describe why preserving cultural heritage is important for society.
 - 2. Explain the Vedic education system in detail. Discuss its aims, main features, the role of the Guru, and the Gurukul method of teaching.
 - 3. How does the study of pottery contribute to our understanding of the transition from Early Harappan to Mature Harappan culture?